
Taiwan Transit Guide

An English-language reference for public transport across Taiwan — metro and rail systems, high speed rail, national and regional bus networks, ferries and bike-share.



FEATURED • HISTORY

The Matra dispute

Two disputes thirteen years apart, usually told as one — the test-track fires an engineering change explains, the seventeen-year lawsuit Matra won, and the walkout that taught Taipei how to buy its next railway.

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Rail & cable

Fixed-guideway transit across Taiwan — metro and light rail in five cities, Taiwan Railway, High Speed Rail, the Maokong and Alishan cable and forestry lines.

李元顯 [HTTPS://COMMONS.WIKIMEDIA.ORG/WIKI/FILE:MRT_TRAIN_AT_PLATFORM_4,_ZHONGSHAN_STATION_20141116.JPG] • CC BY-SA 4.0 [HTTPS://CREATIVECOMMONS.ORG/LICENSES/BY-SA/4.0] • WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Metro

The metropolitan metro network — the lines a rider treats as one railway, under one numbering scheme and one fare system.

Cable

The Maokong Gondola — an aerial ropeway run by a TRTC subsidiary, and the region's only cable transit.

Taichung Metro

Taichung's Green Line — a single steel-wheel, driverless metro linking Beitun, the city centre and the HSR station.

Taiwan High Speed Rail

Taiwan's 350 km high-speed railway, with 12 stations from Nangang to Zuoying and a BOT history that changed during financial restructuring.

Taoyuan Metro

Taoyuan Metro's operating Airport MRT and the separate Green Line project registry published by the city engineering bureau.

Taiwan Railways

Taiwan Railways current station and line data, with historical route architecture kept distinct from the live TDX snapshot.

Kaohsiung Metro

Kaohsiung Metro's Red and Orange Lines and the Circular Light Rail, with TDX metro data and operator/government LRT records kept distinct.

Alishan Forest Railway

Taiwan's 762 mm forest and mountain railway from Chiayi to Alishan, with active sunrise and forest-park branches.

Projects

11 pages

Lines under construction, approved extensions, proposals and abandoned alignments.

History

63 pages

How the railway came to be the way it is — the contracts, disputes and decisions whose consequences are still running.

Technology

13 pages

The technology layer — signalling, power, guideway and automation — and why Taipei runs several of each.

Operators

4 pages

Who actually runs what — TRTC, New Taipei Metro, Taoyuan Metro, and eventually TRA and THSR.



Bus

City and regional bus networks across Taiwan — Taipei's joint-operation system, and the operators, vehicles and fares of Taichung, Kaohsiung, Tainan, Hsinchu and intercity coaches.

捷利 [HTTPS://COMMONS.WIKIMEDIA.ORG/WIKI/FILE:CAPITAL_BUS_683-U5_HEAD_AT_EXIT_Y17,_TAIPEI_CITY_MALL_20230307.JPG] • CC BY-SA 4.0 [HTTPS://CREATIVECOMMONS.ORG/LICENSES/BY-SA/4.0] • WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Bus operators

61 pages

TDX operator records, generated route associations and the fields that still require company or government sources.

Network

3 pages

The joint-operation system — one brand, one fare structure, many private companies — and the route numbering that encodes more than it appears to.

Routes

1051 pages

Individual bus routes — operator, corridor, stop list and frequency.

Bus depots and operating sites

4 pages

Sourced bus stations, dispatch sites and charging-depot procurements, with capacity and opening gaps left visible.

Bus models

10 pages

Sourced bus vehicle records, propulsion evidence and the fields that remain unpublished.

National intercity coaches

0 pages

A source-backed snapshot of Taiwan's national intercity-coach operators, route variants, stops and published departure times.

Regional bus networks

4 pages

City and county bus networks beyond the Taipei core, with dated Hsinchu, Taichung, Tainan and Kaohsiung layers.



Bike

YouBike — the shared bicycle system that is genuinely part of the transit network, with a generational story nobody has told properly in English.

LORD KOXINGA [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Youbike_bicycles_parking_on_shifu_road,_Taipei_City_20100721.jpg] • **CC BY-SA 3.0** [<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0/>] • **WIKIMEDIA COMMONS**

History

1 page

From the Xinyi pilot to the retirement of the first generation — the timeline, dated from primary announcements.

Generations

0 pages

1.0, 2.0 and 2.0E — incompatible by design, and the engineering reasons why.

Stations

29 pages

Browse the committed static YouBike station snapshot by municipality and district.

Air

Taiwan's domestic airport network and the two carriers that operate it — the lifeline flights to outlying islands as much as the Taipei-Kaohsiung-Taichung trunk.

Airports

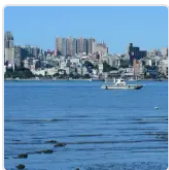
3 pages

Taiwan's domestic and international airports, from Taoyuan's main gateway to the outlying-island fields that exist because ferries alone cannot reach them fast enough.

Operators

1 page

UNI Air and Mandarin Airlines, the two carriers flying Taiwan's domestic network — both descended from smaller regional airlines absorbed into the China Airlines and EVA Air groups.



Ferry

Scheduled passenger boats across Taiwan — the Tamsui/Keelung river Blue Highway, and the outlying-island lifelines to Kinmen, Matsu, Penghu, Green Island and Orchid Island.

TAIWANKENGO [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:2020_Tamsui_Ferry_Pier.JPG] • **CC BY-SA 4.0** [<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0/>] • **WIKIMEDIA COMMONS**

Ferry routes

7 pages

Current Blue Highway routes, Kaohsiung Cijin ferry routes and Penghu, Kinmen, Matsu, Green Island and Orchid Island services, with piers, operators, fares and date-sensitive rules.



Ticketing

Cards, passes and fares — the layer every rider touches and English sources routinely get wrong.

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Guides

7 pages

How payment actually works across the Taipei region — cards, the commuter pass, and fares.

Road

The taxi and ride-hailing regulation that governs the mode most transit trips end with, and the national freeway network the intercity coach system this site already covers actually runs on.

Regulation

1 page

How Taiwan licenses taxis and ride-hailing platforms, and the specific legal mechanism that ended Uber's 2017 shutdown fight.

Network

1 page

The national freeway system as infrastructure — the numbered routes and the electronic-toll-collection system that replaced every staffed tollbooth in 2013.

Statistics

National transport data from MOTC's own surveys — modal share, vehicle ownership, and a live three-way disagreement over how many people die in traffic each year.

National

3 pages

Modal share, vehicle ownership and the traffic-death reconciliation, all from MOTC's own published series.

An independent, non-commercial reference site. Not affiliated with any transit operator or government body in Taiwan. Line colours are the official values published by each operator through Taiwan MOTC's open data platform. [About this site.](#)

Station names, codes and sequence from TDX Transport Data eXchange, Ministry of Transportation and Communications, operators TRTC, NTMC, TYMC, and TMRT. Government open data. Retrieved 2026-08-24; source last updated 2016-11-23. The 12 Sanying station records absent from TDX are sourced directly to New Taipei Metro and government publications on their pages. Provenance.